



Games on Microsoft Teams

Microsoft is working on adding casual games into Microsoft Teams.
<https://digit.in/jul22-33>



Quest VR gets parental controls

Meta is adding parental controls to all its Quest VR headsets; guardians can check user screen time. <https://digit.in/jul22-34>

D-Link DIR-3040 EXO AC3000 Smart Router

Tri-band for all

D-Link has been quite gung-ho about their new smart routers which incorporate support for intelligent assistants such as Amazon Alexa and Google Assistant. Previously, the intelligent features were very rudimentary, however, with the passing of time, these features have grown to encompass more use cases. The DIR-3040 is part of their new EXO lineup of smart routers. And if smart assistants aren't the deciding factor in your purchase decisions, then there is another facet of the DIR-3040 that might pique your interest. It happens to be the most economical tri-band router that you can buy at the moment. It's not Wi-Fi 6 ready but with a tri-band router and some smart configuration, you can work magic with these devices.

BUILD

Before we get into the innards of the device, you should know that the DIR-3060 and the DIR-3040 are the same devices. The only difference is that the DIR-3040 does not feature McAfee protection baked into it. Honestly, we'd rather get a router without an anti-virus baked into it rather than one with it. This is because the anti-virus distributions that are built into routers aren't as configurable as their desktop variants and one wrong signature can really be a pain to get around.

The DIR-3040 uses a MediaTek MT7421A as the main SoC with 256 MB of DDR3 memory. There are two MediaTek MT7615(D/DN) chips for the three bands. The MT7615D is used for the 2.4 GHz and the first 5 GHz bands with a diplexer used to allow both bands to share



the same antennae. There are two antennae attached to the MT6515D. The latter 5 GHz band is channelled via four antennae and there is no diplexer required in this case. This configuration allows 400 Mbps on the 2.4 GHz band, 866 Mbps on the first 5 GHz band that's combined with the 2.4 GHz band. And the second 5 GHz band gets 1733 Mbps. The front ends for all the bands are handled by Qurvo QPF4219 and QPF4519 for the 2.4 GHz and 5 GHz bands, respectively. There's a nice thick heatsink covering the main PCB and there are ventilation slits on the top and bottom sides.

The ethernet ports are all Gigabit Ethernet and the rear of the router has a USB 2.0 as well as a USB 3.0 port. Everything on the back is also colour-coded for convenience. And there's the WPS switch on the front of the router which melds into the housing and becomes flush with it. The antennae are really well-built with a little snapping action happening at 45 degrees and at 90 degrees. Overall, the DIR-3040 is a really well-built router with sev-

eral quality-of-life improvements with the build.

PERFORMANCE

Setting up the router isn't that different. There's the handy wizard which will guide you through all the typical network configurations that are applicable to most households. If you aren't logging into the device using the admin panel, then there's also the handy mobile app which takes care of the set-up process with ease.

We then move on to the performance test for the three bands. The 2.4 GHz band manages to clock in at 166 Mbps for a single client which is quite good. Increasing the distance from the router leads to the throughput dropping to a little below 90 Mbps.

On the second 5 GHz band which has a lot more throughput, we saw a throughput of 540 Mbps when tested up close and around 354 Mbps with some distance put between the router and the client.

As for file transfer using the USB ports, we saw a healthy speed of about 40 MBps which is quite decent for a router.

It's not the highest that we've seen but considering the price point and the number of features that the router has, this is a decent figure.

VERDICT

The router sells itself by the simple fact that it is a tri-band device priced under ₹10K. The DIR-3040 has a decent build and good performance. While it might be a 2-year-old router considering its international launch, it continues to be a relevant and competitive model here in India.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

MODEL: DIR-3040 | WI-FI: 802.11ac | LAN: 4x1 GbE | WAN: 1x GbE | SOC: MT7621AT | WLAN: MT7615DN | DIMENSIONS: 22.2 x 20.1 x 5.9 cms | WEIGHT: 578 kg | WARRANTY: 3 - years.

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